The First British Empire (1600–1783)

KNOWLEDGE RETRIEVAL & HOMEWORK COMPANION • 30 HIGH-YIELD QUESTIONS

Pupil Name: _____ **Class:** _____ **Teacher:** _____



Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II granting the Diwani (civil tax sovereignty) of Bengal to Robert Clive (1765) • Transforming a private London commercial firm into a sovereign territorial empire.

LESSON ENQUIRY FOCUS	HW DUE DATE	1. SOLO (WRITTEN)	2. PARTNER (VERBAL)	PARENT / TEACHER SIGN
Enquiry 1: East India Company in Bengal 1600 Royal Charter, Mughal factories, 1757 Battle of Plassey, Robert Clive & 1765 Bengal Diwani		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 2: Slave Trade & Middle Passage Chattel slavery, Middle Passage, Royal African Company, 1781 Zong Massacre & Olaudah Equiano		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 3: Plantations & Maroon Resistance Sugar plantations ('White Gold'), Cromwell's 1655 conquest, Jamaican Maroons, Queen Nanny & 1739 Treaty		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 4: Thirteen Colonies & Boston Tea Seven Years' War debt, 1765 Stamp Act, 'No Taxation Without Representation', Boston Massacre & 1773 Tea Party		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 5: American Revolution & Loyalists 1775 Lexington & Concord, 1776 Declaration of Independence, Lord Dunmore, Black Loyalists & 1783 Treaty of Paris		/ 6	/ 6	

HOW TO COMPLETE YOUR RETRIEVAL CYCLES:

1. SOLO (WRITTEN): Complete your 6 write-in lines from memory without looking. Check your answers in green pen using the Department Marking Bank on Pages 7–8.

2. PARTNER (VERBAL): Hand your booklet to a **PARENT, CARER, FAMILY MEMBER, OR STUDY BUDDY** to test you out loud from the Marking Bank until you hit 6/6!

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1. ► **In what year did Queen Elizabeth I grant a royal charter establishing the East India Company?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

2. ► **What were the fortified coastal trading warehouses established by the Company in India called?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

3. ►► **How did Robert Clive achieve victory against overwhelming Bengali forces at the Battle of Plassey in 1757?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

4. ►► **What historic imperial grant did Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II sign in 1765 giving the Company civil tax powers over Bengal?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

5. ►►► **Why did the Diwani transform the East India Company into an unprecedented imperial hybrid?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

6. ►►► **How did Company tax extraction and grain speculation contribute to the catastrophic 1770 Bengal Famine?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | Royal Charter (1600) | Emperor Jahangir | Factories | Battle of Plassey (1757) | Robert Clive | The Diwani (1765)

7. ► **What legal system classified human beings as personal property with zero civil rights, inherited across generations?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

8. ► **What was the maritime voyage transporting captive Africans across the Atlantic under brutal confinement called?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

9. ►► **Why did British slave captains enforce "tight packing" on slave ships despite devastating disease mortality?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

10. ►► **How did the 1781 Zong Massacre expose the monstrous legal reality of the British slave trade?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

11. ►►► **What forensic architectural diagram published by abolitionists in 1788 galvanised national outrage across Britain?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

12. ►►► **How did published autobiographies by formerly enslaved Africans like Olaudah Equiano transform the abolitionist movement?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | Chattel Slavery | The Middle Passage | Royal African Company | Tight Packing | Zong Massacre (1781) | Olaudah Equiano

13. ► **What lucrative cash crop was termed "White Gold" because of the immense wealth it generated for British planters in the Caribbean?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

14. ► **What name was given to self-liberated communities of formerly enslaved Africans who fought the British from Jamaica's Blue Mountains?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

15. ►► **Why was sugar cultivation on Jamaican plantations one of the most lethal regimes in human history?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

16. ►► **How did Windward Maroon leader Queen Nanny successfully defeat British redcoat regiments during the First Maroon War?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

17. ►►► **What historic concession was the British Crown forced to grant the Jamaican Maroons in the 1739 Peace Treaty?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

18. ►►► **How did active day-to-day resistance by enslaved people undermine the plantation system from within?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | Sugar Cane ("White Gold") | Cromwell (1655) | The Maroons | Queen Nanny | Guerrilla Warfare | 1739 Peace Treaty

19. ► **What royal decree issued by George III in 1763 forbade American colonists from settling west of the Appalachian Mountains?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

20. ► **What famous constitutional slogan encapsulated American resistance to taxes levied by a London Parliament they did not elect?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

21. ►► **Why did Parliament pass the controversial Stamp Act in 1765 taxing newspapers, legal deeds, and playing cards?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

22. ►► **How did the Sons of Liberty protest the 1773 Tea Act in Boston Harbour on the night of 16 December 1773?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

23. ►►► **Why were Parliament's punitive "Intolerable Acts" of 1774 a fatal political miscalculation by King George III?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

24. ►►► **How did the Enlightenment philosophy of John Locke inspire American colonial resistance to British imperial rule?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | Proclamation of 1763 | Stamp Act (1765) | No Taxation... | Boston Massacre (1770) | Boston Tea Party (1773) | Sons of Liberty

25. ► **Who was the principal author of the American Declaration of Independence adopted on 4 July 1776?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

26. ► **In what year and at which Massachusetts towns was the opening military clash ("the shot heard round the world") fired?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

27. ►► **What 1775 decree issued by Virginia's royal governor promised freedom to enslaved Africans who joined the British army?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

28. ►► **Why did the decisive French military and naval intervention transform the American Revolution into a global defeat for Britain?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

29. ►►► **What profound historical paradox lay at the heart of the 1776 American Declaration of Independence?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

30. ►►► **How did the loss of the American colonies in 1783 force Britain to invent the "Second British Empire"?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | Lexington & Concord (1775) | Thomas Jefferson | Declaration (1776) | Lord Dunmore's Proclamation | Black Loyalists | Treaty of Paris (1783)

Department Marking Bank • Part 1

Green-Pen Verification Key • Enquiries 1 to 3 (Questions 1 to 18)

ENQUIRIES 1–3

ENQUIRY 1: EAST INDIA COMPANY IN BENGAL

1. ► **1600** — *Elizabeth chartered 218 London merchants with an exclusive trade monopoly across the Indian Ocean.* [✓] [X]

2. ► **Factories** — *Factories in Surat, Madras, and Calcutta were fortified warehouses where Company agents ("factors") traded spices, silk, and textiles.* [✓] [X]

3. ►► **Bribing Mir Jafar to betray the Nawab and keeping Company gunpowder dry during a monsoon downpour** — *Clive conspired with Indian bankers to subvert Nawab Siraj ud-Daulah, securing military control of Bengal.* [✓] [X]

4. ►► **The Diwani (Treaty of Allahabad)** — *The Diwani granted the Company the right to collect land taxes from 20 million Bengalis, yielding £2 million annually.* [✓] [X]

5. ►►► **It turned a private commercial joint-stock firm into a sovereign ruler collecting taxes and commanding armies** — *A London corporate boardroom held sovereign executive power over an empire larger than Britain, answering to private shareholders.* [✓] [X]

6. ►►► **The Company maintained brutal tax collection and hoarded food during a drought, causing up to 10 million deaths** — *Prioritizing corporate profit over famine relief exposed the ruthlessness of company rule, forcing Parliament to pass the 1773 Regulating Act.* [✓] [X]

ENQUIRY 2: SLAVE TRADE & MIDDLE PASSAGE

7. ► **Chattel slavery** — *Enslaved people were legally defined as property, purchasable, taxable, and inherited by maternal descent.* [✓] [X]

8. ► **The Middle Passage** — *The Middle Passage formed the central leg of the Triangular Trade, forcing millions into horrific, unventilated holds.* [✓] [X]

9. ►► **They calculated that packing maximum captives yielded higher net auction profits even after 15% mortality** — *Captains treated human beings as freight, calculating that surviving numbers would offset deaths from dysentery and smallpox.* [✓] [X]

10. ►► **Captain Collingwood threw 133 living captives overboard to claim maritime insurance payouts for lost cargo** — *British courts initially treated the deliberate drowning of 133 human beings as an ordinary cargo loss, shocking the public.* [✓] [X]

11. ►►► **The Brookes slave ship plan ("Description of a Slave Ship")** — *The diagram showing 454 men, women, and children packed onto wooden shelves provided undeniable visual proof of systemic cruelty.* [✓] [X]

12. ►►► **Providing articulate firsthand moral witness to the horrors of trafficking, shattering racist pro-slavery arguments** — *Equiano's 1789 autobiography became a national bestseller, turning abstract debate into an undeniable human and moral crisis.* [✓] [X]

ENQUIRY 3: PLANTATIONS & MAROON RESISTANCE

13. ► **Sugar cane** — *Sugar transformed British diets and generated astronomical mercantile profits that financed British banks, estates, and early industries.* [✓] [X]

14. ► **The Maroons** — *Maroons established autonomous communities in rugged mountains, maintaining West African traditions and military resistance.* [✓] [X]

15. ►► **Exhausting 18-hour workdays, tropical diseases, and boiling house accidents caused horrific mortality rates** — *Planters worked enslaved people to death and purchased fresh captives from Africa rather than sustaining the population naturally.* [✓] [X]

16. ►► **Using camouflage, mountain ambushes, and guerrilla warfare in narrow mountain gorges** — *Queen Nanny's warriors disguised themselves with tree branches and communicated using the abeng horn, repelling repeated British invasions.* [✓] [X]

17. ►►► **Recognised Maroon sovereignty and granted them 1,500 acres of autonomous crown land** — *Britain was forced to sign a formal peace treaty with self-liberated Africans, acknowledging their freedom and legal independence.* [✓] [X]

18. ►►► **Through sabotage, breaking tools, feigning illness, poisonings, and cultural preservation, proving slavery was never accepted** — *Enslaved Africans waged continuous resistance, proving that freedom was maintained through agency despite totalitarian plantation laws.* [✓] [X]

Department Marking Bank • Part 2

Green-Pen Verification Key • Enquiries 4 to 5 (Questions 19 to 30)

ENQUIRIES 4–5

ENQUIRY 4: THIRTEEN COLONIES & BOSTON TEA

19. ► **The Royal Proclamation of 1763** — *Britain sought to stabilize frontier relations with Native nations, outraging colonial land speculators who felt entitled to western territory.* [✓] [X]

20. ► **"No Taxation Without Representation"** — *Colonists argued that under British constitutional law, free Englishmen could not be taxed without their own elected representatives.* [✓] [X]

21. ►► **Pay off the massive national debt incurred defending the American colonies during the Seven Years' War** — *Britain argued colonists should contribute to the cost of 10,000 British troops stationed in America, provoking riots.* [✓] [X]

22. ►► **Disguising themselves as Mohawks and dumping 342 chests of British East India Company tea into the ocean** — *Protesters destroyed £10,000 worth of tea to prevent Company monopoly imports, prompting Parliament to pass punitive Coercive Acts.* [✓] [X]

23. ►►► **Shutting Boston port and suspending Massachusetts self-government united previously divided colonies in resistance** — *Instead of isolating Boston, the authoritarian crackdown prompted all thirteen colonies to unite in the First Continental Congress.* [✓] [X]

24. ►►► **Colonists argued that when a government violates natural rights to liberty and property, citizens have a duty to overthrow it** — *Locke's social contract theory provided the intellectual justification for dissolving ties with the British monarchy.* [✓] [X]

ENQUIRY 5: AMERICAN REVOLUTION & LOYALISTS

25. ► **Thomas Jefferson** — *Jefferson articulated the foundational doctrine that all men possess unalienable rights to "Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness".* [✓] [X]

26. ► **1775 (at Lexington and Concord)** — *British redcoats marching to seize colonial gunpowder clashed with Minutemen, igniting the American Revolutionary War.* [✓] [X]

27. ►► **Lord Dunmore's Proclamation** — *Over 20,000 enslaved Black men and women fled plantation bondage to join the British forces as "Black Loyalists".* [✓] [X]

28. ►► **French warships trapped General Cornwallis at Yorktown in 1781, cutting off British naval supply and escape** — *French naval mastery at the Chesapeake forced Cornwallis to surrender 8,000 troops, breaking Britain's political will to continue the war.* [✓] [X]

29. ►►► **It proclaimed "all men are created equal" while its wealthy authors held hundreds of human beings in chattel slavery** — *Jefferson and other founders demanded liberty from British "enslavement" while perpetuating hereditary racial slavery in America.* [✓] [X]

30. ►►► **Britain shifted imperial expansion from western settlement colonies to conquest across India, Asia, and Australia** — *Losing thirteen American colonies redirected British imperial focus toward the East India Company, African commerce, and penal transportation to Botany Bay.* [✓] [X]

UNIT CONCEPTUAL FOUNDATIONS • 4 CORE ANCHORS

MERCANTILISM: The economic system where European empires used colonies exclusively to enrich the mother country through monopolies and Navigation Acts.

CHATTEL SLAVERY: A legal system treating human beings as personal property with zero civil rights, inherited across generations by maternal descent.

THE DIWANI: The imperial charter of 1765 granting the East India Company the right to collect land revenues from 20 million people across Bengal.

REPRESENTATION: The democratic principle that citizens cannot be legally taxed by a parliament where they have no elected representatives.